

Keystone — Architecture & Platform Strategy

We don't standardize the metric — we standardize the source of the metric.

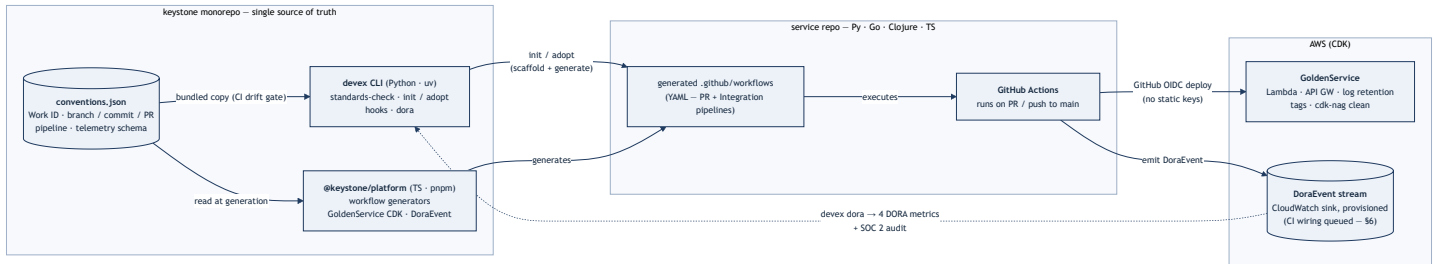
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2 Git-installable packages · 117 tests (86 py + 31 ts) · 4 ADRs · live OIDC deploy on real AWS · 6 inner-source fixes from one real adoption

The problem. 10+ independent full-cycle teams reinvent CI/CD, infrastructure, and conventions per repo. DORA metrics are not comparable across stacks (Python, Go, Clojure, TypeScript), SOC 2 evidence is reconstructed by hand, and Developer Experience — the actual product of a platform team — is fragmented.

The decision. Build the Golden Path as two independently versioned, Git-installable packages — `devex` (Python CLI, `uv tool install`) and `@keystone/platform` (TypeScript framework, `pnpm add`) — wired to **one** source of truth (`conventions.json`) and **one** telemetry contract (`DoraEvent`). The packages never import each other; every convention a team must follow is defined once and structurally enforced everywhere — by the same file, at every layer. Comparability, governance, and audit become structural properties, not policies teams are asked to remember.

1. Architecture



Key properties. The CLI and the framework integrate **only** through `conventions.json` and the documented event schema — no code dependency in either direction, which is what keeps both Git-installable on independent SemVer lines (`cli-vx.Y.Z` / `framework-vx.Y.Z`, ADR-0001). The CLI is self-contained: it bundles a synced copy of `conventions.json` (Pydantic-validated on every load; a CI gate fails on drift). Because the **framework** — never the application — generates CI and emits telemetry, every team's pipeline and every team's events are identical by construction (ADR-0002).

2. Homologation — adoption is engineered, not requested

Lever	Mechanism
One-command adoption	<code>devex init</code> (new service) / <code>devex adopt</code> (existing) drop in the generated PR + Integration pipelines, PR template, and <code>keystone.json</code> ; git hooks are an explicit opt-in (<code>devex hooks install</code>). The reference adoption: zero application-code changes; the first standardized CI run caught 6 latent bugs.
One definition, two consumers	Every convention — Work ID (FIN-123), branch/commit/PR patterns, pipeline stages, telemetry vocabulary — exists once in <code>conventions.json</code> . No regex is duplicated in Python or TypeScript; the CLI validates locally with exactly the rules the generated CI re-runs. Drift is structurally impossible, not reviewed away.
Identical pipelines by construction	Generated <code>small-tests</code> (unit + property-based + server-less OpenAPI schema validation), OIDC deploy stages, and <code>DoraEvent</code> emission are the same shape for every language behind one <code>LANGUAGE_TOOLCHAINS</code> interface.
Governance as code	Conventional commits anchored to a Work ID; PR-title gate; two-reviewer rule shipped as a version-controlled GitHub ruleset (ADR-0003) — change-management evidence an auditor can query.

Rollout for 10+ existing teams: cohort-based — start with the highest-traffic repo per language family; `devex adopt` touches no application code and is mergeable in a single PR mid-sprint. The forcing function is the DORA dashboard itself: a team that hasn't adopted has no metrics to show, and visibility is the incentive. **Anti-patterns rejected:** per-team CI templates (drift by design), conventions as policy documents (unenforced = optional), per-language metrics SDKs (defeats comparability — ADR-0002), and golden paths harder to follow than to bypass (a platform bug, not a teams problem).

3. Scalability — the platform team is not in the critical path

- Self-serve extension.** Languages live behind one typed interface; the `new-language` runbook makes adding a stack a contracts-only contribution — no platform-team gatekeeping for the common case.
- Inner-source, proven not promised.** One real adoption surfaced **six platform gaps** — install, toolchain, contract-testing, CI-checkout, and deploy-job defects — each fixed as a small reviewed PR to the platform (FIN-308, 309, 311, 312/313, 314, 316). Three were findable **only** by running the pipeline live. The next team inherits every fix.
- Distribution that scales without a registry.** Pinned Git tags are the release artifact. The framework ships a **prebuilt dist/** (ADR-0004) — no build-on-install, no package-manager allowlists (`pnpm ≥ 11.5` blocks git-dep build scripts) — with a CI freshness gate so the committed artifact can never drift from source.
- The platform team's actual job:** own two contract points — `conventions.json` and the `DoraEvent` schema — curate contributions, run the release line. Everything else (workflow YAML, construct props) is consumer-readable and PR-able by any engineer; known edge cases are tracked as public, ticketed issues (§6). Not the job: writing or debugging per-team CI.

4. Shift-left — the same rules at four layers

- Workstation:** `devex standards-check` + opt-in git hooks fail in seconds, with the exact rules CI enforces — and the failure tells the developer how to fix it:

```
$ devex standards-check
✓ branch OK
X commit invalid: 'update stuff'. Expected e.g. 'feat(api): FIN-123 add payment validation'
```

- Pre-push:** `devex pipeline run --local` simulates the pipeline before anything leaves the machine.

2. **PR pipeline (generated):** re-runs the conventions gate, unit + property-based tests, and validates the OpenAPI schema **server-less** — contract checking is split: schema pre-deploy, fuzz the deployed URL post-deploy (FIN-314). *Pre-deploy live-fuzzing is an anti-pattern: the endpoint doesn't exist yet.*

3. **Deploy:** GitHub **OIDC** (no static keys, least-privilege role scoped to the repo) → sandbox → staging → production promotion, each stage emitting telemetry.

Keystone dogfoods its own gate: the monorepo's CI runs the same conventions checks and drift gates it ships to adopters.

5. DORA & audit — one event, two consumers

Every generated deploy stage emits one `DoraEvent` — required fields `event`, `workId`, `actor`, `repo`, `env`, `commitSha`, `commitTime`, `timestamp` (the four W's, Work ID as the auditable "why"; `runId` as optional correlation). All **four DORA metrics are computable today** — deployment frequency, lead time (`timestamp - commitTime`), change-failure rate, MTTR — by `devex dora` over the stream, never instrumented per language. The same row is the SOC 2 record (CC6.1, CC7.2/7.3, CC8.1): evidence collection is a query, not an interview. **Proven on real AWS:** the framework's TypeScript `buildEvent / serializeEvent` produced the events, they were round-tripped through the construct-provisioned CloudWatch log group, and the Python CLI computed the four metrics from the read-back stream — TS contract, Python consumer, one schema. The case-study service deployed through OIDC from CI ([public run 27309574910](#)), emitting its real `deployment.succeeded`; routing that CI emission into the CloudWatch sink is a queued trigger (§6).

6. When to reconsider — explicit migration triggers

- **Committed `dist/` → registry publish** [ADR-0004] — the day a private registry is available; the freshness gate retires with it.
- **Trunk branch as a generator option** — fires when trunk divergence affects a second adopting service; the case study already hit it once (trunk named `master`, integration pipeline keyed to `main`).
- **Commit-gate on protected-branch pushes** — fires the first time a team's trunk run goes red on a GitHub merge commit; the fix is the FIN-313 skip applied to the trunk (queued, ticketed).
- **CI events → CloudWatch sink + post-deploy fuzzing** — fires when the first team consumes `devex dora` from the shared stream rather than from run summaries; the sink is already provisioned by `GoldenService`.

Appendix — measured impact (Transactionify case study). *Before:* no CI ever ran its tests · suite drifted from its own code · conventions unenforced · deploys manual. *After (zero app-code changes):* 6 latent bugs caught on the first standardized run, red → green on one PR · 6 platform gaps fixed upstream · real AWS sandbox deploy from CI via least-privilege OIDC, verbatim `DoraEvent` captured · four DORA metrics computed from the real stream · teardown verified to zero resources under a \$5 budget alarm. Full narrative: [docs/case-study-transactionify.md](#).